

31 Conditional sentences overview

31.1 TYPES OF CONDITIONAL

The zero conditional
is used to talk about situations that will always happen. It is used to talk about general truths.

PRESENT SIMPLE
If you play the violin out of tune, it sounds terrible.
PRESENT SIMPLE



The second conditional
is used to talk about hypothetical situations that are very unlikely to happen, but are usually still possible.

PAST SIMPLE
If I practiced more, that song would sound better.
"WOULD" + BASE FORM



31.2 USING COMMAS IN CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

When the action comes before the result, a comma separates the two clauses of the conditional sentence. However, when the result comes first, no comma is used.

When **you freeze water**, **ice forms**.

A comma is used if the action comes first.

Ice forms when **you freeze water**.

The result can come at the beginning of the sentence.

"If" or "when" can sit between the action and result, without a comma.